

Archipel's recipe for virtualisation

Ingredients

To install the agent you need:

- libvirt
- eJabberd
- A supported Linux distribution with kvm and qemu
- Python
- Python setup tools
- Subversion

For the client installation:

- A Web server
- Python

Method

- Set up the Jabber server. Instructions are available in the wiki. For a Debian-like distribution, for example, I followed the steps at [link \[1\]](#).
- As the root user, run the following commands:

```
easy_install archipel-agent
archipel-initinstall
archipel-tagnode --jid=admin@FQDN --password=YOURPASSWORD
--create
archipel-rolesnode --jid=admin@FQDN
--password=YOURPASSWORD --create
archipel-adminaccounts --jid=admin@FQDN
--password=YOURPASSWORD --create
archipel-vmparkingnode --jid=admin@FQDN
--password=YOURPASSWORD --create
```

Start the agent:

```
/etc/init.d/archipel start
```

Check the status of both the agent and the Jabber server; you should see them as running:

```
sudo ejabberdctl status
sudo /etc/init.d/archipel status
```

For the client installation, all you need to do is unzip the archive into your Web server's deployment directory and you're done!

down and restarting your Virtual Machines from Google Talk over your Android phone! Yes, the future is here!

As for the Archipel agent, it runs on the virtualisation server and with the help of libvirt, Python and xmpppy, provides an interface for the client Web app to communicate with the hypervisors and VMs. The client Web app, on the other hand, is based on Objective-J and is developed on the Cappuccino JavaScript framework that gives us an eye-catching UI.

Starting up

After everything is installed and is up and running, you can go to the Archipel Web app and enter your login credentials



Figure 1: The login screen



Figure 2: General preferences



Figure 3: The VM configuration screen

(Figure 1) as you did while installing eJabberd or any Jabber server that you might have used. After you get authenticated and a bit of loading, you'll be able to see the UI of Archipel. Here, you'll be able to add your hypervisor to your contacts with its Jabber ID and assign a nickname to it (Figure 2). You can even add other members of your team and talk to them right from this interface. It is like having an IM client along with a virtualisation solution.

To create a new VM, you can click on the hypervisor, then go to the *Virtual Machines* tab and click the plus button at the bottom. After you name the VM, and accept its subscription request, you'll be able to see that it has been added to your contacts on the left. On clicking the name of a particular VM, you'll be able to see various tabs on the right that allow you to configure and start/stop your machine. Archipel also provides a small VNC console that displays the screen of the VM and allows you to zoom in or out of the current view, etc (Figure 3).